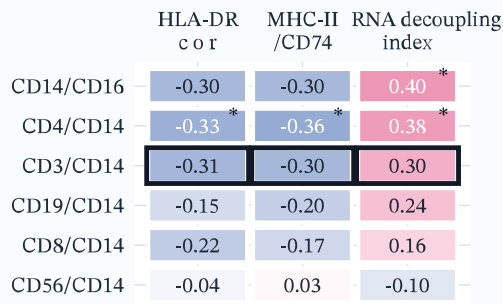


A Prespecified marker-pair correlations

40 sepsis-only raw-FCS paired rows.



Spearman ρ



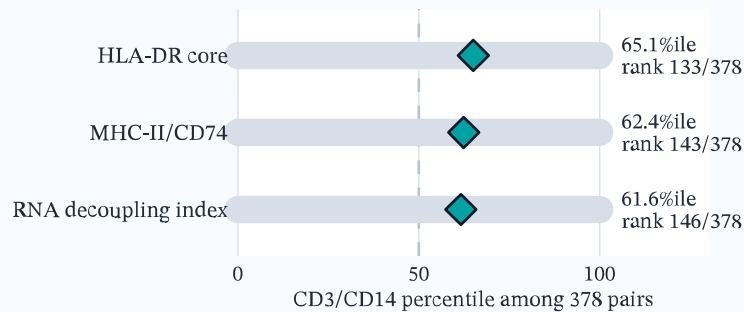
-0.6 -0.3 0.0 0.3 0.6

Star, permutation $p < 0.05$; outline, CD3/CD14.

For RNA decoupling index, CD14/CD16 and CD4/CD14 exceed CD3/CD14.

B All-pair marker-null rank context

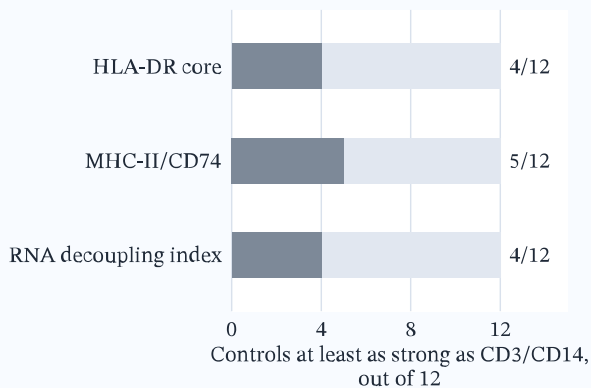
378 marker pairs; CD3/CD14 marked in teal.



Ranks based on absolute Spearman ρ .

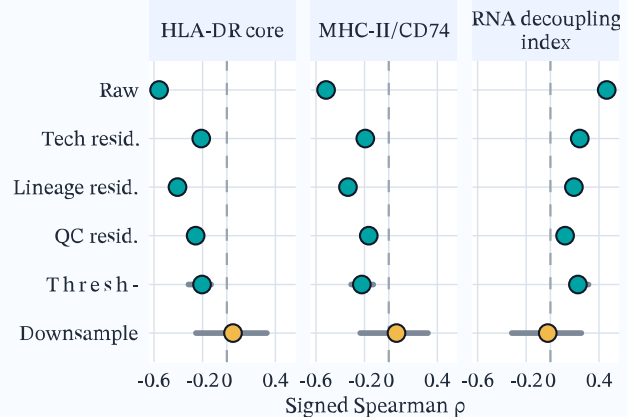
C Abundance-matched control comparison

Controls with absolute Spearman $\rho \geq$ CD3/CD14.



D Sensitivity ladder

Expected direction preserved after threshold and technical residualization; downsampling attenuated.



Orange circle: Attenuated; Teal circle: Expected direction

CD3/CD14 retained as a prespecified representative residual co-event signal;
pair-level specificity remains unresolved.